

Who Should Read This Book and Why

This book targets those who have completed a basic Python tutorial and want to know more. The tutorial you learned from could have been my previous book, *Automate the Boring Stuff with Python* (No Starch Press, 2019), a book such as *Python Crash Course* (No Starch Press, 2019) by Eric Matthes, or an online course.

These tutorials might have hooked you on programming, but you still need more skills. If you feel like you're not yet at the professional programmer level but don't know how to get to that level, this is the book for you.

Or perhaps you were introduced to programming via another language besides Python and you want to jump right in to Python and its ecosystem of tools without retreading the same *Hello, world!* basics. If so, you don't need to read hundreds of pages that explain basic syntax; instead, skimming the “Learn Python in Y Minutes” article at <https://learnxinyminutes.com/docs/python/> or Eric Matthes's “Python Crash Course—Cheat Sheet” page at <https://ehmatthes.github.io/pcc/cheatsheets/README.html> will suffice before you tackle this book.

About This Book

This book covers more than just deeper-level Python syntax. It also discusses using the command line and the command line tools that professional developers use, such as code formatters, linters, and version control. I explain what makes code readable and how you can write clean code. I've featured a few programming projects, so you can see these principles applied in actual software. Although this isn't a computer science textbook, I also explain Big O algorithm analysis and object-oriented design.

No single book can transform a person into a professional software developer, but I've written this book to further your knowledge toward that